# رَائِيَّة

# Raa Iya

KHASSIDA · 38 VERS

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Khadimou Rassoul · Serigne Touba

KIRAAM

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

# رَائِيَّة

# Raa Iya

قَلْبِي لَهُ فِي عِتَابِ الْجِسْمِ تَكْرَارُ

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Œuvre de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul

1 partie · 38 vers · mètre Rajas

English translation only

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# Raa Iya 1

1. My heart keeps on reproaching the body, for it draws toward guidance and light.

2. It blames my body ceaselessly for sitting idle without knowledge or deeds; and the soul is deceitful.

3. It never ceases to call it to good and draw it, and to happiness, ceaselessly, while it stays (motionless) settled.

4. It blames it, while it is under constraint and in chains, by my Lord's leave; and the prisoner is most dutiful.

5. Procrastination and persistence have held my body back from what the heart seeks of virtues.

6. So today I have turned my face, repentant forever, to Allah, with the repentance of one whom the All-Forgiving (Al-Ghaffār) has drawn near.

7. O All-Forgiving, forgive my sins and loose my chain, by him toward whom it is a shame for me to have neglected visiting him,

8 by him who addresses me, in visiting his garden, (with) two verses from the saying of one who enjoins recognised good:

9 "Visit the one you love, even if the abode is far from you, and plains and rugged places lie between.

10 Let no distance prevent you from visiting him: the lover is an assiduous visitor of the one he desires."

11 To You I have already repented of my word and my deeds, and of all that I used to choose.

12 I have turned my face to You today, seeking from You pardon for what sins have marred.

13 I have turned my face to You today, hoping to be with You like those who made the pilgrimage and those who visited (the Prophet).

14 Grant me by Your grace, O Bestower (Al-Wahhāb), O my King, to be with You like one who visits in spirit,

15 by the standing of him to whom, wherever the masters draw near, (he is) a sun approached, in a clear sky, by moons;

16 or (as though) he were among them, to what the eye sees, a sea around which are wells and rivers.

17 The full moon has an immense light by which one is lit, but (only) when the sun does not appear.

18 The reed has height in the eye of whoever looks at it, but (only) when no trees have grown around it.

19 The well has water sweet to drink, but it is (but) drops from the gulf of the sea.

20 Dew is water, but not like the pouring downpour; and the rains do not match with water the bounty (of the Prophet).

21 That is the refuge through which I hope for salvation in this world and the Next: would that I were a neighbour around him!

22 And he is the one my body has been kept from visiting, but my tongue, like the heart, is his assiduous visitor.

23 He has upon me, for the Countenance of Allah, a debt of fine praise, every year, on the day that is chosen.

24 And he is the noble one, in describing whose form and character rhymed prose and poems have been spoken.

25 And the eloquent and the rhetoricians have not brought, with rhymed prose and poetry, a tenth of what he attained.

26 The people of eloquence all praised him with laudation; but the torrent is not reached with cups.

27 Kaʿb, Ḥassān and al-Būṣīrī have already excelled, and the poetry of all of them is light and secrets.

28 "The utmost knowledge about him is that he is a man" (Burda), and that beneath him are intellect and thoughts.

29 So do not compare the son of ʿAbd Allāh with the excellent: truly the stars are hidden by Sinimmār (with his lofty edifice, al-Khawarnaq).

30 The Chosen, the best of Allah's creatures, has a rank such that, were all creation to turn toward it, they would be bewildered.

31 Creation sought to attain grace, hastening toward it; and grace, with the Messenger of Allah, is settled.

32 Both his hands have a striving that attends them: largesse and might, for whoever softened and whoever was unjust.

33 He has of knowledge what no man has contained, nor jinn, nor angel; and the breast is overflowing.

34 He has with Allah a secret that monks and rabbis do not scan, with toil and knowledge.

35 The rain, before the outpouring of the pious one's bounty, is abashed; and the lion of the forest, for fear of him, flees.

36 He has of forbearance what no mountain has contained; he met harm among creatures, and he is most patient.

37 "Truly the Messenger is a sword from which light is drawn, an Indian blade among the swords of Allah", cutting (Kaʿb ibn Zuhayr).

38 Each, of all the elect, has a rank; but Aḥmad, the Chosen, is (truly) chosen.

# رَائِيَّة

## Raa Iya

قَلْبِي لَهُ فِي عِتَابِ الْجِسْمِ تَكْرَارُ ۞ لِأَنَّهُ لِلْهُدَى وَالنُّورِ جَرَّارُ

« Mon cœur a, dans le reproche au corps, une insistance, car il attire vers la droite guidance et la lumière. »

« Raa Iya » est un khassida de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul, guide spirituel et fondateur de Touba. Cette édition réunit ses 38 vers en arabe vocalisé, avec leur translittération et leur traduction.

ENGLISH